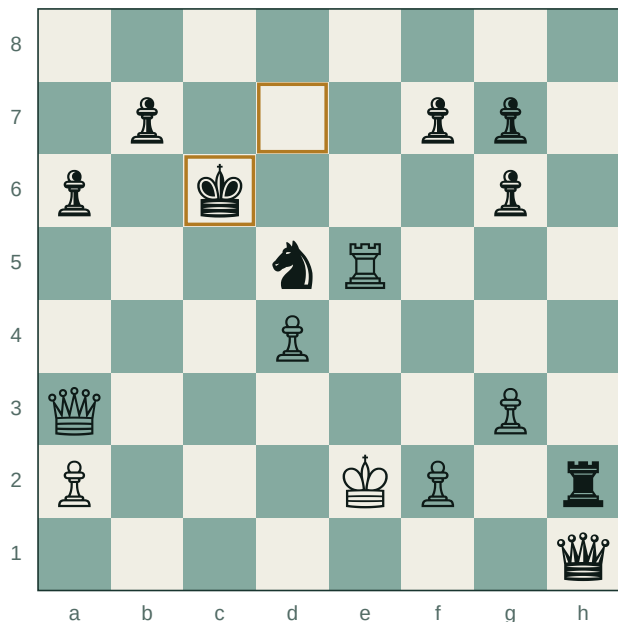


Deflection tactics: White, move 33

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Kc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Qc5+ Kd7 34. Rxd5+ Qxd5 35. Qxd5+

33.Qc5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From c5 it attacks king on c6 and knight on d5. Recorded reply: **33...Kd7**.

34.Rxd5+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on d5. Recorded reply: **34...Qxd5**.

35.Qxd5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -4 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on c6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.